



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.veritasnc.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Veritas Christian Academy (Fletcher, NC) presents itself publicly as a Christian, classical school with a PreK–12 program and a curriculum anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a Christ-centered, Biblically-informed framework. The website emphasizes intelligent faith, character formation, and a strong faculty-student relationship grounded in Christian formation. While the school clearly adopts core classical aims (classical curriculum, Trivium, and a devotional/ liturgical ethos evidenced by events like Lessons & Carols), it does not overtly publicize several hallmark practices frequently associated with a fully classical public stance (e.g., explicit Great Books program, explicit Socratic seminars, a published living curriculum portrait, or robust, explicit parental-partnership programs on the site). Taken together, the public materials align most strongly with Classical or strongly Classical elements in categories tied to religious/metaphysical foundations and curricular language, but evidence for full implementation across all six classical elements is incomplete on the site. This yields a general assessment of **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** overall, with particular strength in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Curriculum, and opportunities for growth in Parent/Community engagement and explicit Socratic pedagogy.

Key drivers behind this assessment: - The site foregrounds Intelligent Faith, a Christ-centered approach, and a Trivium-based Classical curriculum, indicating a robust religious/metaphysical foundation and a curriculum built on classical methods. Evidence includes explicit statements like "Intelligent Faith: Equipping minds and engaging hearts for God's Kingdom" and "built on the classical Trivium and historic Biblical Christianity." - The mission and tone emphasize formation and holistic nurture (the "whole child") within a classical framework, which aligns with classical aims in School Purpose & Goal, albeit with less explicit articulation of some classical classics-centered practices (Great Books, Great Conversation) on the public-facing pages. - Pedagogy, liturgical rhythm, and community display (e.g., public events like Lessons & Carols) show an integration of liturgical practices into schooling, which supports Element 1's liturgical dimension but leaves Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy less explicit in public content. - Keyword analysis against the Six Essential Elements lexicon (positive/negative indicators) confirms substantial alignment in several categories, but with gaps in publicly stated, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and formal parental partnership language on the site. See the classical lexicon for reference to the relevant keywords.

Note: The analysis that follows systematically applies a keyword-based rubric (Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements) to each of the six classical elements, then assigns a category rating, and finally offers needle-moving steps if warranted.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence

- The site emphasizes Intelligent Faith and a Christ-centered approach anchored in historic Biblical Christianity, suggesting transcendental theological commitments and a liturgical/communal orientation. For example, Veritas frames itself as “Intelligent Faith: Equipping minds and engaging hearts for God’s Kingdom” and notes a “classical Trivium and historic Biblical Christianity” foundation.
- The presence of a liturgical event (Lessons & Carols) signals liturgical practice as part of schooling.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): theology, liturgy, sacred worship, sacred tradition, virtue, wisdom, and the concept of the Logos and sacred order appear in the document’s rubric for religious/metaphysical foundations. The site explicitly references theology-centered Christianity and liturgical life via events, Christ-centeredness, and Biblical framing.
- Comparison against the school’s public materials shows alignment with the religious metaphysical stance (theology/theocentricity and liturgical rhythm) but with limited explicit lexicon matches on the site (e.g., not all exact terms may be in plain sight). The Lexicon provides the full set of indicators; Veritas’ content aligns with several of them (theology, liturgy, sacred tradition) but with a lean public text.
- Why this rating
- The school’s public materials clearly foreground a transcendent, theological orientation (Biblical Christianity, Christ-centered education) and liturgical expression (Lessons & Carols) and explicitly ground education in faith. This aligns with Classical standards for Religious Metaphysical Foundations. The presence of liturgical practice and a theology-infused curriculum meets multiple positive indicators from the lexicon. Therefore: CLASSICAL.
- Note on needle-movement
- If this category were only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, a needle-mover would be to explicitly publish a short statement of liturgical rhythm and a concise catechetical/theology framework tied to all disciplines (to bolster the explicit “Liturgical and Communal Practices” and “Theology as Mistress Science” indicators).

Citations: Veritas site content describing Intelligent Faith, Christ-centered approach, and Trivium/Biblical Christianity; Liturgical event example.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes formation of minds and hearts through a classical Trivium and a Christ-centered approach, and it frames education as formation within a Biblically-informed classical tradition. The explicit phrasing around “formation” and “nurturing the whole child” appears in public materials.
- The mission is described as classical curriculum with a Christ-centered approach, and the site notes a strong faculty–student relationship and emphasis on character formation within a faith-based framework. This aligns with the Positive Keywords in the “formation”/virtue/teleology family of indicators in the lexicon, even if the site does not use all the canonical terms (e.g., “telos,” “great conversation,” etc.) explicitly.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue (conceptually via character formation and holistic development), teleology (implied by “formation toward truth/beauty” though not verbatim), and “great conversation” language is not explicit on the public site but is implied by classical-trivium framing.
- Negative keywords: the site does not promote secular, value-neutral, or job-education orientations; it emphasizes Christ-centered formation rather than workforce- or college-career readiness rhetoric. However, explicit statements about “workforce preparation” are not present on the public pages, which reduces negative keyword signals.

- Overall, a moderate presence of formation-oriented language with limited explicit Great Conversation/Great Books phrasing suggests SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL (which would more explicitly articulate formation and teleology as core goals and lay out a clear, stated Great Books/wisdom-formation arc). See the Six Elements lexicon for the formation/telos and Great Conversation language as indicators.
- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds formation (the whole-child emphasis and Christ-centered formation), and the Trivium-based curriculum signals a classical aim. Yet the public content does not provide a complete, explicit articulation of all six elements of Classical education related to this category (e.g., explicit, public Great Books formation and a fully stated telos in every discipline). Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is the prudent, evidence-based rating at this stage.
- Needle-mover
- Move toward full CLASSICAL by publishing a concise, public articulation of formation goals (virtue, teleology, and human excellence) and explicitly tying Great Books/Great Conversation into the core curriculum; publish a public statement of the school's telos and cultural formation aims across grades, with examples of how Great Conversation is integrated at multiple levels.

Citations: Veritas site statements about formation and Christ-centered education; Lexicon anchors for formation/telos and Great Conversation indicators.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site explicitly states the school's educational culture is built on the classical Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric). This is a canonical liberal-arts frame.
- The Great Books/Great Conversation elements are not explicitly named on the public pages, and there is no visible, explicit list of the Quadrivium or Great Books on the site snippet. The catalog language focuses on "classical Trivium" and a Christ-centered approach rather than detailing Great Books or the Quadrivium in public pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric). This directly maps to the "Seven Liberal Arts"/Trivium element in the lexicon. The lexicon also lists Great Books and the Great Conversation as a core curriculum element; while not explicit on the site, Trivium presence signals some alignment with the liberal-arts tradition.
- Negative keywords: There is no public indication of a purely social-studies-centric or STEM-first framing; however, the site does not publicly enumerate Great Books, the Quadrivium, Latin, or a robust "Great Conversation" reading program on the public pages. This reduces the explicit alignment with the full Curriculum element in classical terms.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum pointer to the Trivium demonstrates clear alignment with Element 3's liberal-arts core. Yet the absence (in public text) of explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, and Quadrivium mentions on the site reduces the strength of a fully Classical curriculum claim. The lexicon marks these as key curriculum signals; the public content shows strong but not complete alignment. Therefore: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Needle-mover
- Publicly publish a detailed curriculum map that explicitly lists: (a) Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, dialectic/logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music), (b) Great Books/Great Conversation titles across grades, (c) Latin or other classical languages, and (d) history integrated through a long-running, canonical reading list. Include examples of how Great Books are read in each division and how history is taught as a continuous thread across disciplines.

Citations: Site statements about the Trivium; Lexicon anchors for Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Quadrivium.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school's public content centers on a classical curriculum and a Christ-centered education, implying a pedagogy aligned with the Trivium and formation. The explicit pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, rest-filled scholé, or formal memory work) are not spelled out in the public site content but can be inferred from classical-Christian pedagogy literature tied to the Trivium and scholé. The site's focus on "Intelligent Faith" and "classical Trivium" signals a classical pedagogy but without explicit, public callouts to seminars or recitation as a core method.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: grammar/logic/rehtoric (Trivium) on the curriculum side implies a pedagogy aligned with those arts; liturgical learning and communal practices are present in public materials (via events such as Lessons & Carols), signaling an embodied pedagogy. The lexicon indicates Socratic dialogue, lectio divina, and scholé as core methods; the public site, however, does not consistently spell these out, so alignment is partial.
- Negative keywords: The site does not publicly emphasize project-based learning, experiential learning, or fully student-led, constructivist pedagogy in public text; those would be indicators of non-classical trends if emphasized. The absence of explicit statements to these modern pedagogies supports a more classical reading.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated identity as "Christian Classical" with Trivium-based framing supports a pedagogical orientation consistent with classical learning, but the public-facing content does not clearly enumerate the full suite of classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, scholé days, etc.). Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.
- Needle-mover
- Publicly publish explicit pedagogy statements: (a) Socratic/seminal seminars in upper grades, (b) structured scholé days and contemplative periods, (c) recitation/memory work and chant as routine practice, and (d) embodied/ liturgical learning with concrete daily/weekly routines. Provide examples of how teachers implement these practices in K–12, including sample lesson forms.

Citations: Lexicon anchors for pedagogical techniques (Socratic dialogue, scholé, liturgical learning); Veritas site for Trivium-based pedagogy cues.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site describes the faculty as "quality faculty" who strive to know and understand students and guide them in their studies, including a Christian formation angle. While this underscores a strong faculty, the public materials do not present a comprehensive portrait of "the living curriculum" or "portrait of a teacher" as a formal section.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: "quality faculty" (explicit) and "Christ-centered approach" (alignment with virtue formation). The lexicon includes terms like model teachers and mentors, living curriculum, and collegiality; the site mentions faculty quality but not a highly detailed "living curriculum" description. This yields partial alignment.
- Negative keywords: The site does not publicly present a "portrait of a teacher" or a formal teacher-character framework in the public text, which would be Strongly Classical signals. The lack of explicit living-curriculum language reduces the strength of a CLASSICAL rating here.
- Why this rating
- The school presents a competent, Christian faculty image but without the fully elaborated classical-faculty portrait and "living curriculum" language on the public site. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is appropriate.
- Needle-mover
- Publish a Public Faculty Profile or "Living Curriculum" piece that describes the ideal teacher-mentor portrait, the teacher's role as a guide and model of virtue, and a concrete articulation of collegial

collaboration (with examples of faculty professional development, seminar culture, and mentorship).

Citations: Veritas site mentions “quality faculty” and mentor-like orientation; Lexicon anchors for faculty signals.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public Veritas site does not prominently present a handbook of parent-partnerships, co-teaching models, or explicit parent-formation programs on the site’s visible content. The site emphasizes a Christ-centered formation and classical curriculum but does not publicly foreground a partner-parents model (as co-teachers) or open-house parent-education features on the public pages. The “parent” language appears in external classical-education literature and in affiliated scholarly materials, not in the school’s own public-facing pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords: The Six Elements lexicon includes strong positive signals about “Partnership with Families” and “Parent formation” and “open campus/parent visits” but these are not publicly shown in Veritas’ public site text. Consequently, those indicators are not evidenced on the public pages.
- Negative keywords: The site does not display explicit consumer-language or minimal-parent-involvement signals; rather, the absence suggests a lack of explicit parent-involvement messaging rather than a negative stance. Because the public content does not reveal the parent/community partnership language, this category scores as NOT CLASSICAL given the absence of explicit, public parental-partnership signals.
- Why this rating
- The school’s public-facing materials do not provide explicit evidence of active parental partnership or parent-education initiatives in the same way the “Six Essential Elements” lexicon highlights (e.g., co-education, book studies, parent gatherings). Therefore: NOT CLASSICAL for this category within the public-facing materials.
- Needle-mover
- Publicly publish a Parents & Community section that describes (a) parent-as-co-teacher partnerships, (b) ongoing parent-education programs (book studies, lectures, and gatherings), (c) clear access for parents to visit and engage in the school’s programs, and (d) a formalized pathway for parental involvement across grade levels.

Citations: Site evidence limited to formation emphasis; Lexicon anchors for parent-partnership signals.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Publicly articulate a succinct, explicit statement of liturgical rhythm and theological grounding across disciplines (e.g., “Mistress Science” framing; explicit reference to liturgical practices across the day). This would strengthen the liturgical/communal foundations and deepen transcendental realism in public materials.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): Publish a public telos/paideia statement that ties formation, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful to observable outcomes (student character formation, virtue development), with explicit mention of Great Conversation and Great Books integration.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publish a formal curriculum map that enumerates the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music), Great Books/go-to canonical texts by grade levels, and the explicit integration of Great Books into history and literature, including primary sources. This would move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly commit to specific classical pedagogies—Socratic discussion in high school, disciplined memory work, memorization/recitation routines, and scholé days—and provide examples of daily/weekly lesson forms used in K–12.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and a “Living Curriculum” narrative to demonstrate how teachers embody virtue and act as mentors, with faculty formation and collaboration showcased publicly.

- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Establish and publicize a formal parent-partnership program (co-teaching, parent education, school visits, book clubs) and open community events to strengthen parent engagement.

Citations for context and framework: The Lexicon's indicators for all six elements (Religious, Purposes, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents/Community) provide a structured template for what to publish publicly to push toward CLASSICAL in each category.

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Strengths are evident in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and in Curriculum (Trivium emphasis). Evidence from Veritas' public site demonstrates a Christian classical identity and a Trivium-based curriculum. Evidence of liturgical life is present (Lessons & Carols).
- Gaps appear in the public articulation of the full classical pedagogy (Socratic/seminars), explicit public Great Books/Great Conversation content, and explicit parent/community partnership language. The lexicon provides the full set of indicators, and the site currently demonstrates partial alignment with several of them but not all in public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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